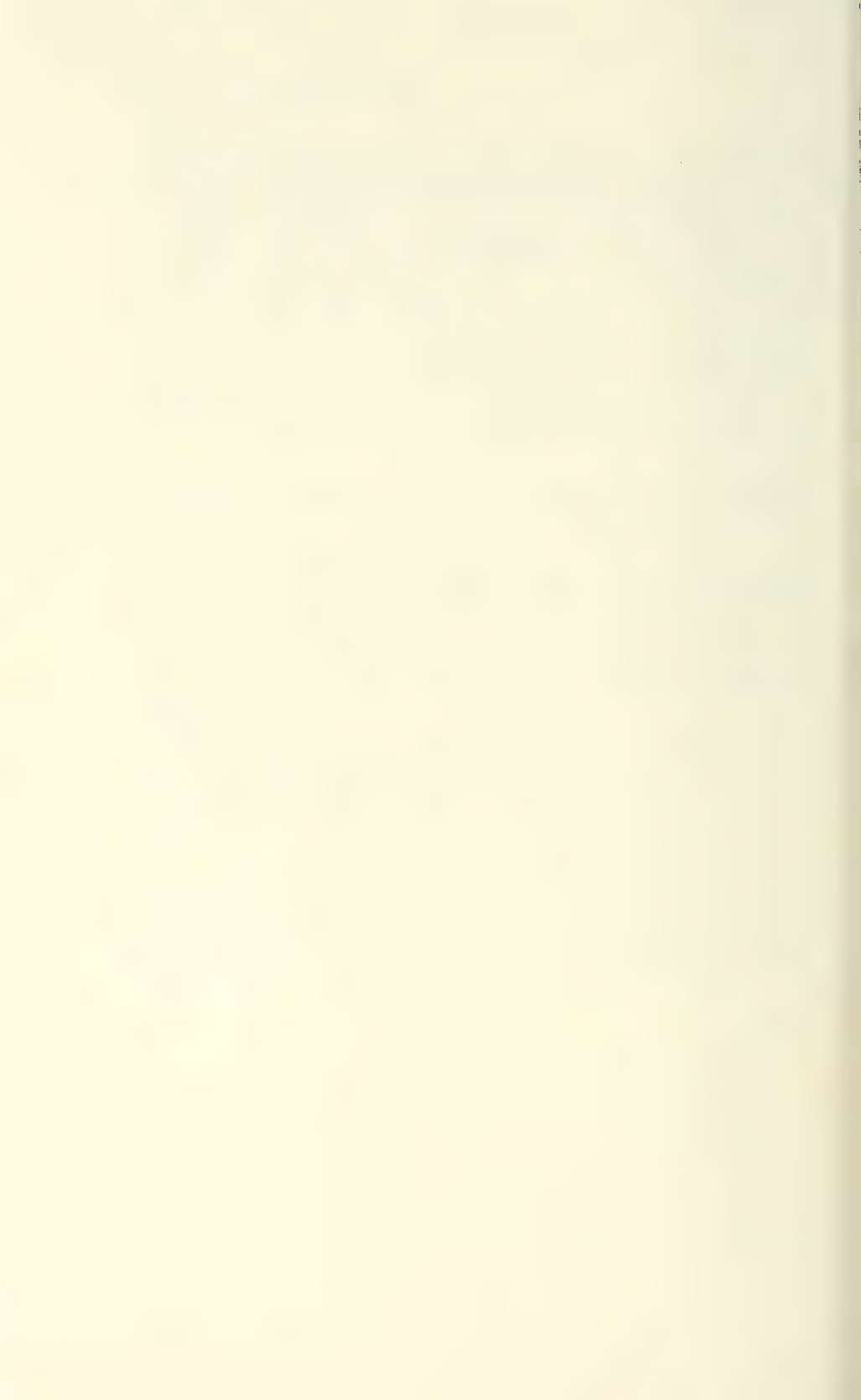


2 From Philosophy to Psychology



ants - actively go out & collect things
- methodical - collect knowledge through

7 Empiricism: The Authority of Experience

Spiders - web (let things come to them)
- getting away from under the sun

We must not corrupt our hope. To prostitute our past-cure
malladie to Empiricks.

William Shakespeare, *All's Well That Ends Well*, 1602

An empirical law, then, is an observed uniformity, presumed to be
resolved into simpler laws, but not yet resolved into them.

J. S. Mill, *A System of Logic*, 1846

A mere Rationalist (that is to say, in plain English, an Atheist of
the late Edition).

Sanderson, Preface to *Ussher's Power of Princes*, 1670

According to rationalism, reason furnishes certain elements,
without which, experience is not possible.

Fleming, *Philosophical Vocabulary*, 1857

The empirical philosophers are like to pismires [ants]. . . . The
rationalists are like the spiders.

Bacon, *Apothegms*, 1626

Coming to Terms . . .

There is a largely undefended convention adopted by historians of psychology
of presenting rationalism as the nearly mechanical "cause" of empiricism and
materialism. On this construal, empiricism is to be understood as a long reply
to the claims of the rationalists, and materialism as a refinement of or inference
from empiricism. Thus we learn (over and over again) that the "father" of
modern empiricism (allegedly John Locke) set out to overturn the theory of
"innate ideas" advanced by that patron of modern rationalism, René Descartes.
It does not seem to trouble those who subscribe to this thesis that Locke never

1st time -
modern method for
science

Bacon proposed exp. method.